

GETTING STARTED WITH LITERATURE REVIEWS

AI Tools in Research Workshop Series

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Why Literature Reviews Feel Hard

- Too many search results
- Unclear where to begin
- Hard to keep track of what you've read

What a Literature Review Is (and Isn't)

- ✗ An annotated bibliography
- ✗ A paper with a source quota
- ✗ A summary of everything written
- ✓ A map of the scholarly conversation
- ✓ A way to show how your research fits in
- ✓ A tool for identifying themes, gaps, and questions

You're Not Starting from Scratch

You already have useful sources:

Course readings

Advisor recommendations

Articles you've heard
referenced repeatedly



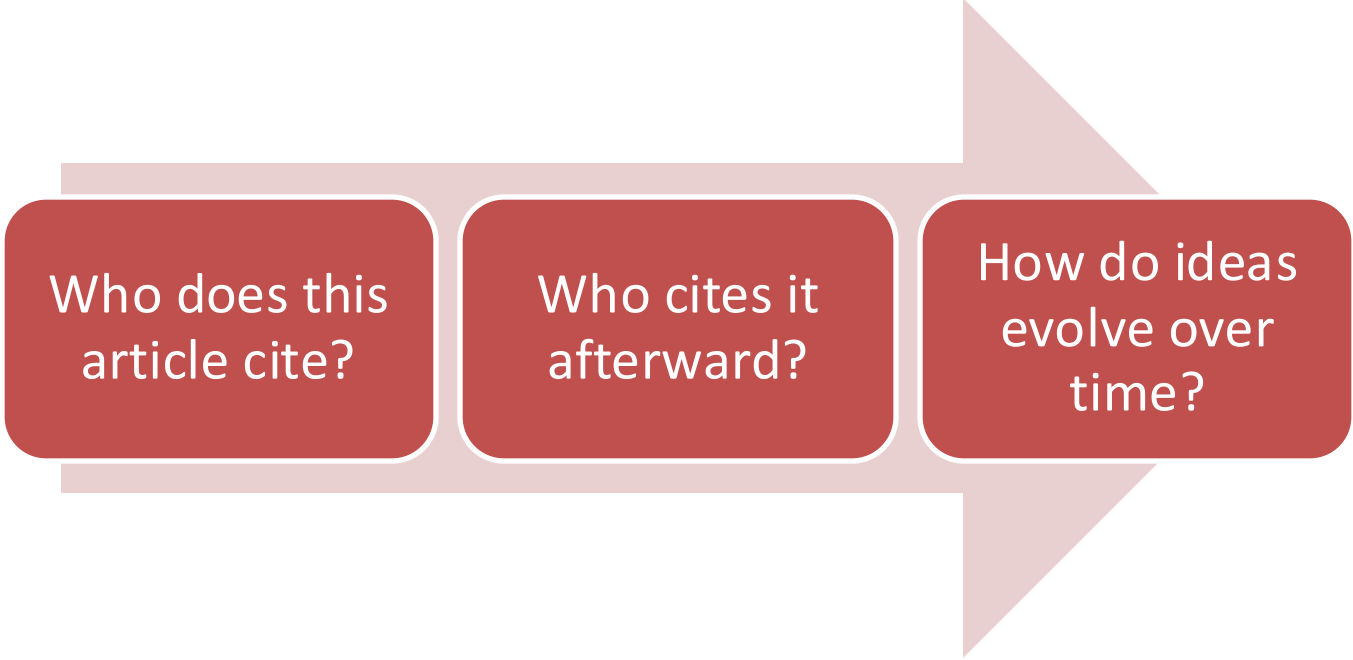
Use these as your first step!

Start with Known Landmarks

- Begin with articles you already know are important
- These serve as anchors for exploring outward



Follow the Conversation



Who does this
article cite?

Who cites it
afterward?

How do ideas
evolve over
time?

Tools That Help

Google Scholar

"Cited by" and "Related articles"

Semantic Scholar

AI summaries and citation context

Research Rabbit

Visual citation networks and timelines

Google Scholar

☰ My profile ★ My library



Google Scholar

☒ Articles ☐ Case law

Stand on the shoulders of giants

Sematic Scholar



SEMANTIC SCHOLAR

A free, AI-powered research tool for scientific literature

Search 229,308,315 papers from all fields of science

Search 

Try: [Feng Zhang](#) • [Cognition](#) • [Carbon Cycle](#)

Research Rabbit



Search Strategically



Fill gaps in your topic



Find recent work



Test your understanding
of the field

Get Help from a Librarian



Subject librarians can:

- Recommend databases
- Improve your search strategy
- Help you focus your topic

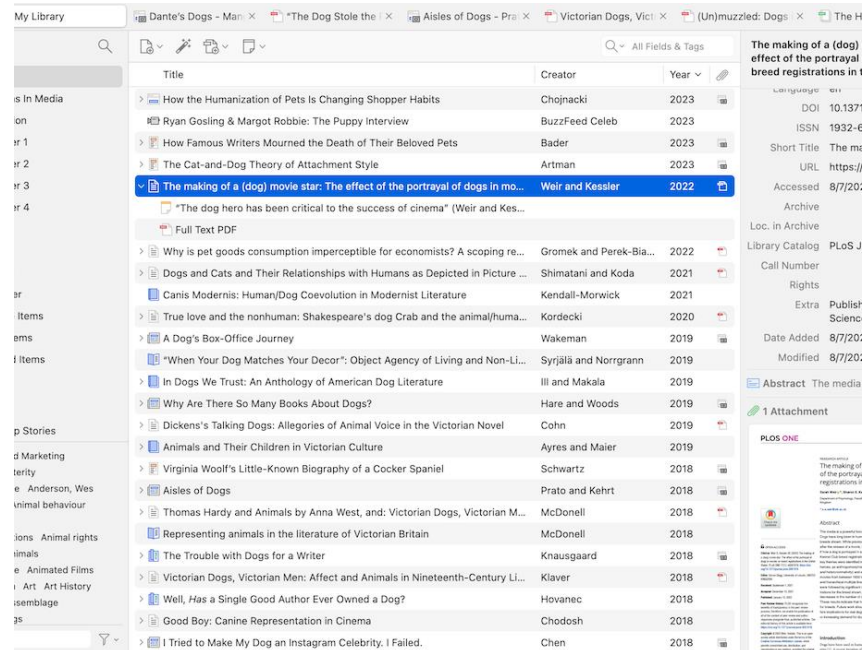
Use a Citation Manager

- Organize and tag sources
- Add notes and attach PDFs
- Generate citations as you write



Zotero: Free and Supported

- Save citations from your browser
- Organize with folders or tags
- Works with Word and Google Docs



The screenshot displays the Zotero web interface. On the left is a sidebar with a search bar and a list of folders/tags. The main area shows a table of citations with columns for Title, Creator, and Year. The citation 'The making of a (dog) movie star: The effect of the portrayal of dogs in movie...' by Weir and Kessler (2022) is selected. To the right of the table, a detailed view of this citation is shown, including its DOI, ISSN, Short Title, URL, Accession Number, and a list of related items.

Title	Creator	Year
How the Humanization of Pets is Changing Shopper Habits	Chojnacki	2023
Ryan Gosling & Margot Robbie: The Puppy Interview	BuzzFeed Celeb	2023
How Famous Writers Mourned the Death of Their Beloved Pets	Bader	2023
The Cat-and-Dog Theory of Attachment Style	Artman	2023
The making of a (dog) movie star: The effect of the portrayal of dogs in movie...	Weir and Kessler	2022
Full Text PDF		
Why is pet goods consumption imperceptible for economists? A scoping re...	Gromek and Perek-Bia...	2022
Dogs and Cats and Their Relationships with Humans as Depicted in Picture ...	Shimatani and Koda	2021
Canis Modernis: Human/Dog Coevolution in Modernist Literature	Kendall-Morwick	2021
True love and the nonhuman: Shakespeare's dog Crab and the animal/huma...	Kordecki	2020
A Dog's Box-Office Journey	Wakeman	2019
"When Your Dog Matches Your Decor": Object Agency of Living and Non-Li...	Syrjala and Norrgrann	2019
In Dogs We Trust: An Anthology of American Dog Literature	Ill and Makala	2019
Why Are There So Many Books About Dogs?	Hare and Woods	2019
Dickens's Talking Dogs: Allegories of Animal Voice in the Victorian Novel	Cohn	2019
Animals and Their Children in Victorian Culture	Ayres and Maier	2019
Virginia Woolf's Little-Known Biography of a Cocker Spaniel	Schwartz	2018
Aisles of Dogs	Prato and Kehrt	2018
Thomas Hardy and Animals by Anna West, and: Victorian Dogs, Victorian M...	McDonell	2018
Representing animals in the literature of Victorian Britain	McDonell	2018
The Trouble with Dogs for a Writer	Knausgaard	2018
Victorian Dogs, Victorian Men: Affect and Animals in Nineteenth-Century Li...	Klaver	2018
Well, Has a Single Good Author Ever Owned a Dog?	Hovanec	2018
Good Boy: Canine Representation in Cinema	Chodosh	2018
I Tried to Make My Dog an Instagram Celebrity: I Failed.	Chen	2018

The making of a (dog) movie star: The effect of the portrayal of dogs in movie...

Language: en
DOI: 10.1371
ISSN: 1932-6
Short Title: The ms
URL: https://
Accessed: 8/7/2020
Archive
Loc. in Archive
Library Catalog: PLoS J
Call Number
Rights
Extra: Publist
Date Added: 8/7/2020
Modified: 8/7/2020
Abstract: The media
1 Attachment

PLOS ONE

The making of a (dog) movie star: The effect of the portrayal of dogs in movie...

Abstract:

The making of a (dog) movie star: The effect of the portrayal of dogs in movie...

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- Finds full-text through your library
- Adds download links to publisher and Google Scholar pages



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Save the citation first



Download PDFs only when needed



Keep your library clean and searchable

Literature Reviews Take Practice

- You're learning to:
 - Read critically
 - Organize scholarly arguments
 - Find your voice in the conversation
- Look at examples of read grad student lit reviews:
 - Visit ProQuest Dissertations & Theses Global

You're Not Alone

- Get help with:
 - Zotero
 - Search strategy
 - AI research tools
- Book a one-on-one with your librarian

Questions?

- For help with technology and tools:
Contact digitalresearch@american.edu
- Book a one-on-one with your librarian
for help with your literature review
([find out who your librarian is](#))
- [Companion website for this workshop](#)